

include provisions to sort of divide up the data cake. Because, one of the great things about the internet—particularly the internet outside China—is that it is so fluid, it doesn't recognise geography. The internet is something that everyone can relish and partake in and build businesses and communicate with each other. And that's also true for social media. And I think the great risk would be if India were to say, 'Oh, well, we're going to hoard all this data for ourselves'; and then Vietnam will say, we'll do that next; and then the European Union; and the US. And before you know it, the global internet, as we know it, will have disintegrated, will have fragmented. That is why we believe that it is in India's own interest to keep the data flows open. And particularly, at a time when the Europeans and the US have just recently entered into a new agreement to ensure the continued open data flows across the Atlantic. And I think India and Europe and the US are the tripod for the future governance of the online world. And the more that India, Europe, and the US can align and work together, the better for us all.

Q: Let us talk about the impact apps like Instagram have on the psyche of young kids, adolescents, teenagers, and with so much research coming out on that. What are you doing to make these apps safer for young children?

A: You mentioned research. As it happens, the research is not conclusive. [Because there is] quite a lot of research that suggests that for the vast majority of youngsters, being able to find a community... find people they can associate with and share their experiences with is a very good thing for their own sense of well-being. But of course, for people who are not feeling great about themselves or dealing with challenging issues in their lives anyway, and particularly if they are passively scrolling and not interacting with other people, then it's not always a great experience. What we try and do is understand that and then find and build features in Instagram, which will help both parents and kids get the best experience. Over the

ON REGULATING ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

AI has been around for years. At Meta, we've been using AI for ages; anything you see on Facebook or Instagram has, in one way or another, been touched by AI. How to regulate AI is a question of first working out what harms and problems you're trying to deal with. Is it intellectual property and copyright or is it misinformation, and then ask yourself whether the current laws are sufficient or not

ON THREADS

It is a work in progress, where new features will be added over time. Threads is a slightly kinder alternative to Twitter. It will become part of something called the fediverse, where you will be able to interoperably share your content across different sites, like Mastodon, for instance. It'll be a much more open platform

ON INDIA'S DIGITAL PROWESS

India already has the world's second-largest community of developers. For the country, it is not a question of if; it is a question of when India becomes one of the great digital superpowers of the world

last several months, we've rolled out 30 new features... you can limit the amount of time on Instagram, with far greater parental controls... I think both with the research and with the new features that we're rolling out, everyone, whether its governments, parents, families, kids, ourselves, [we will] make sure that any experience online for young people is as wholesome and as positive as it can be.

Q: One of the big concerns about the use of social media has been fake news. And while Meta partners with various organisations globally to tackle fake news, one of the big concerns is AI models were being skewed in a way that they started thinking that fake news was real. How do you prevent that?

A: The thing to remember about AI and misinformation, or indeed any undesirable, deep fake disinformation, anything that we don't want on the platform, is, yes, it is true that AI might make it a bit easier for someone to produce a fake image... that's not new, but you might be able to do it more quickly now. But conversely, AI is [also] our best defence. I'll give you one very concrete example. The prevalence or proportion as a percentage of the total content on Facebook of hate speech today is now as low as 0.02 per cent. That means if you're scrolling through your news feed endlessly, and you saw 10,000 bits of content, [only] two bits of content might be hate speech... it has reduced by over 50 per cent over the last couple of years, precisely because of AI. And the thing to remember about content moderation systems on platforms like Facebook is from our point of view, it doesn't matter whether it's a human being or a robot that produced the bad content, our systems will still try to pick that up, regardless of how it's been generated... I'm quite optimistic that the latest advances in AI will almost help strengthen our defences as much if not more so than help people produce bad content. **BT**

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